

HTC Launches Three New Smartphones for the Indian Market

Taiwanese smartphone maker HTC recently launched its brand new Android-powered smartphone—the HTC One (M8). With it came an array of developer initiatives. **Faisal Siddiqui, Country Head, HTC**, spoke to **Prasid Banerjee** from **Open Source For You** about the new SDKs, its new models targeting the mid-range and budget segment, as well as HTC's commitment to the Indian market.



Faisal Siddiqui, Country Head, HTC

With its newest smartphone out in the market, it seems that HTC has made some important changes. For one, the company, which has been known to put high price tags on its devices, has come up with a high but strategic pricing for its new flagship model. In addition, the company has a lot to offer developers, who can lay their hands on a couple of juicy SDKs.

The M8 comes with Sense 6, a new version of the HTC's smartphone user interface. For the first time, the Sense UI comes with an open SDK and the company is inviting developers to work their magic. "By opening the SDK, we're expanding the scope of Sense 6. There are a lot of things that developers can come up with, which we may not think of," said Siddiqui.

The Sense UI indeed offers a lot of scope to developers. The Blinkfeed, which is one of its primary components, can easily be a developer's dream. For the uninitiated, the Blinkfeed is a compilation of your entire social network, news and some other apps. It gives you easy access to them. The SDK can be obtained from the company's developer website and developers only need to approach HTC.

The Sense UI isn't the only new open SDK though. The highlight of HTC's new device is its dual camera lenses, which have made way for some attractive new features. The addition of the second lens, which resides above the regular camera lens, gives the user features like copy/pasting elements from a picture. This means you can pick up elements from one photo and insert them in another. It has other features too, like refocusing an image after it has been clicked. While the camera is still the 4 Ultrapixel model that was seen on the HTC One, the company's developer site says it brings high-quality DSLR effects to a smartphone.

A dual camera, though, can do a lot more, says the company, which is why HTC also has an open SDK for it. The company is confident that the new feature can lead to a lot of innovation. The 'shoot first and change focus later' as well as the copy/paste features were showcased by Siddiqui himself at the launch event. So having the open SDK for the dual camera brings developers into the fray, which Siddiqui said should bring about some exciting new